

A guide to accessing identification materials on the CITES Checklist

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1. Introduction

CITES regulates international trade in more than 36,000 species of animals and plants. Parties are expected to implement the Convention for all listed species, which means that CITES authorities, scientists, and enforcement officers must be able to tell these species apart. A number of materials have been developed to aid Parties in this task, including the CITES Identification Manual and materials hosted on the CITES Virtual College.

The *CITES Identification Manual* is a collection of data sheets designed to help identify species of fauna and flora with drawings, photographs, maps and concise descriptions. The **CITES Virtual College** hosts a collection of identification resources produced by the CITES Secretariat, CITES Parties, and non-governmental organisations, and includes websites, apps, and downloadable guides. To increase the accessibility of these materials, as well as to allow users to create custom packages of identification materials for specific taxa, these materials can now be accessed directly through the *CITES Checklist*.

This guide outlines important aspects to consider when using these materials, and highlights the three different routes via which identification materials can be accessed from the CITES Checklist.

1.1 Background

The contents of the CITES Identification Manual were published over a 29 year period, from 1980–2009. Sheets from the identification manual, as well as materials from the CITES Virtual College, are provided as they were originally published. As such, no warranty of any kind is given as to the completeness or accuracy of the content. It should be noted that identification materials may not

available for some species, and CITES Identification Manual materials may be absent particularly for species listed in CITES after 2009.

Users should additionally note that the CITES listing and taxonomy of taxa described in the materials available may have changed since the materials were first published. Tags for each particular taxon have been reconciled to align with current CITES Standard References, but the file name for each individual sheet will reflect the name of the taxon as shown within its content. For current CITES nomenclature and listing information, users should refer to the main Checklist of CITES Species site and dedicated downloads for listings/names.

1.2 Languages

The CITES Identification Manual contains materials available in the three working languages of the Convention (English, French and Spanish), but materials in French and Spanish are available for fewer taxa. Materials are provided in the language specified where possible, but where materials are not available in French and Spanish, they are instead provided in English. Materials from the Virtual College may be available in a wider variety of languages, with available options shown in the “Select language” dropdown.

2. Accessing Materials

There are three ways to access identification materials via the CITES Checklist:

- 1) Full downloads and downloads of specific volumes of the CITES Identification Manual
- 2) **Custom downloads** – users can create a customized PDF of CITES Identification Manual sheets for specific species groups (filterable by Appendix/location).
- 3) **Individual taxon entries** – users can access CITES identification manual sheets and materials hosted on the CITES Virtual College for specific taxa.

Materials can also be accessed from the [Species+ CITES document library](#).

2.1 Full Download And Downloads Of Specific Volumes

The CITES Identification Manual in its entirety can be downloaded in PDF format by clicking the “CITES Identification Manual” download button under “Featured” in the righthand panel of the Checklist site. Users can specify whether they wish to download the manual in full, or can specify specific volumes (e.g. Mammalia, Aves, etc.) to download.

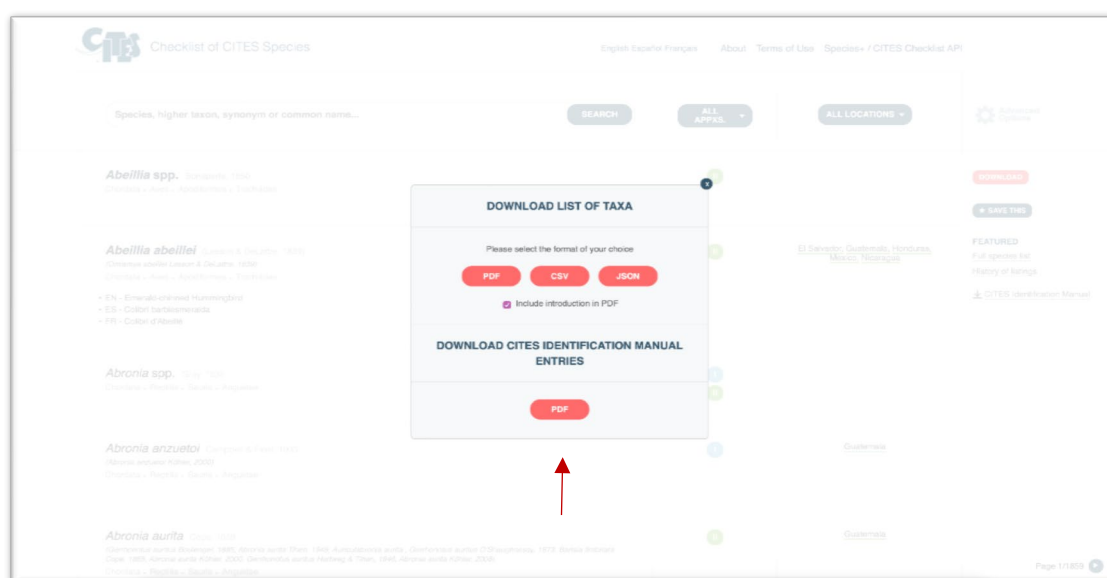
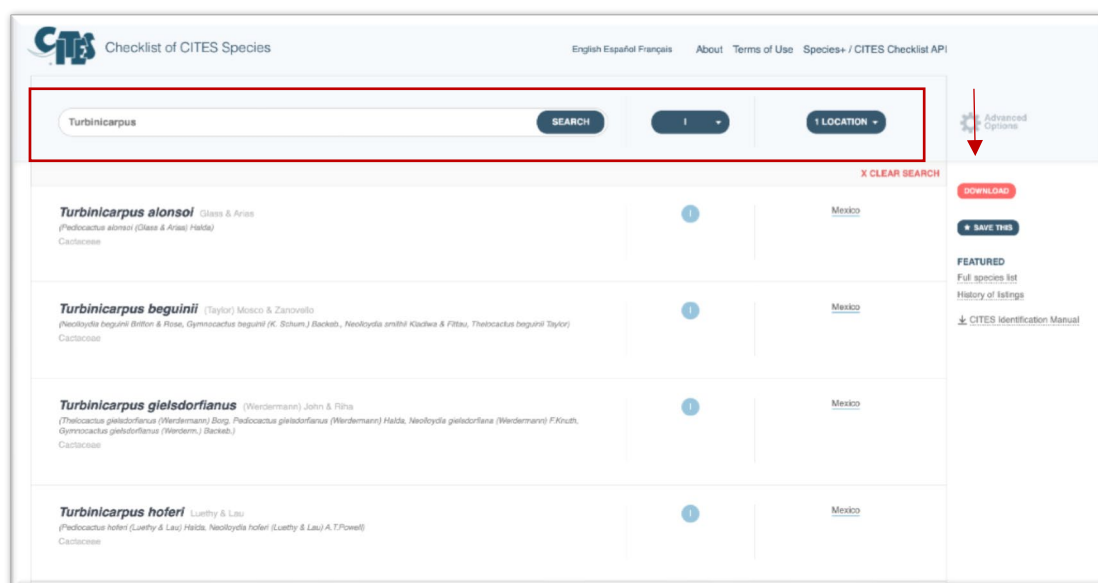
The screenshot shows the CITES Checklist of CITES Species website. The header includes the CITES logo and navigation links for English, Español, Français, About, Terms of Use, and Species+ / CITES Checklist API. Below the header is a search bar with the placeholder text "Species, higher taxon, synonym or common name..." and buttons for "SEARCH", "ALL APPKS", and "ALL LOCATIONS". A "Advanced Options" gear icon is also present. The main content area displays a list of species. The first species is *Abellia* spp. (Bonaparte, 1850), followed by *Abellia abellei* (Lesson & DeLatre, 1839) and *Abronia* spp. (Gray, 1828). To the right of the species list, there is a "FEATURED" section with links for "Full species list", "History of listings", and a red-bordered link for "CITES Identification Manual" which is highlighted by a red arrow.

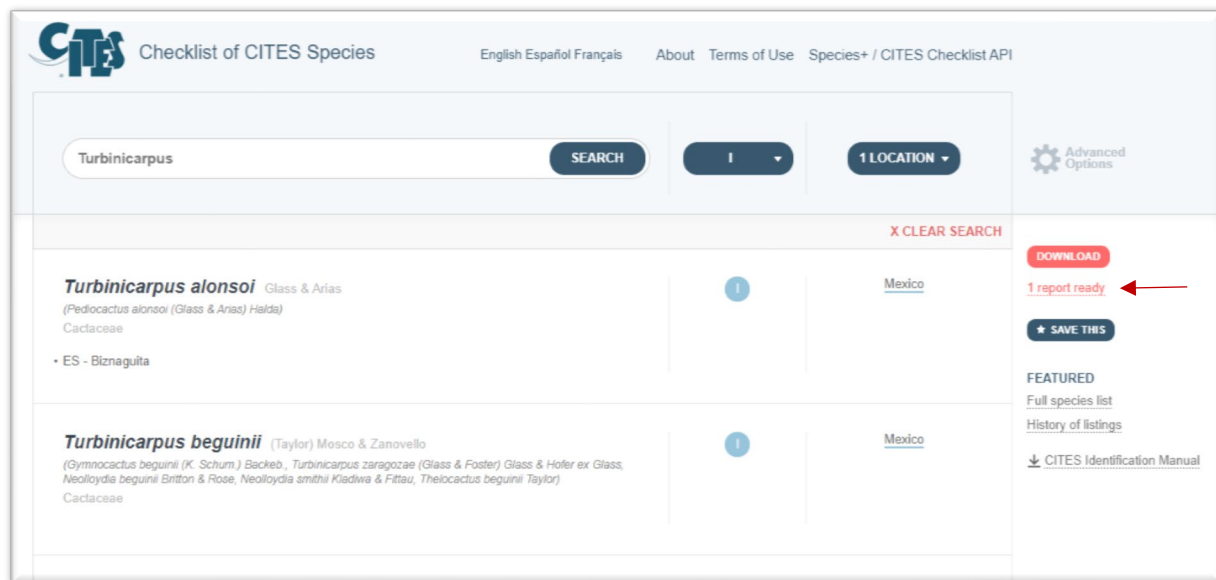
This screenshot shows the "CITES IDENTIFICATION MANUAL (1980-2009)" download modal. The modal has a title bar and a close button. It asks the user to "Please select volume(s) you wish to download (PDF format only)". There are several checkboxes for different volumes: "All volumes", "Vol. 1 Mammalia", "Vol. 1 Flora", "Vol. 2. Birds", "Vol. 3 Reptiles, Amphibia, Pisces, Invertebrata", "Vol. 4 Plants and Derivatives I", and "Vol. 5 Plants and Derivatives II". Below the checkboxes are two buttons: "DOWNLOAD SELECTED" and "or Download all volumes". A red arrow points to the "Download all volumes" button. The background of the website is visible but slightly dimmed.

2.2 Custom Downloads

Users can download custom packages of materials from the CITES Identification Manual through the Checklist's search, filter and download function. After searching for a particular taxon and applying the desired filters (e.g. for Appendix and location), clicking on the red 'DOWNLOAD' button will give an option for users to download either a list of taxa, or a compilation of identification materials for their search. Customised downloads may take some time to compile, however users can close the report generator window and continue working in the Checklist. Once a report is ready, a notification will appear in the righthand column.

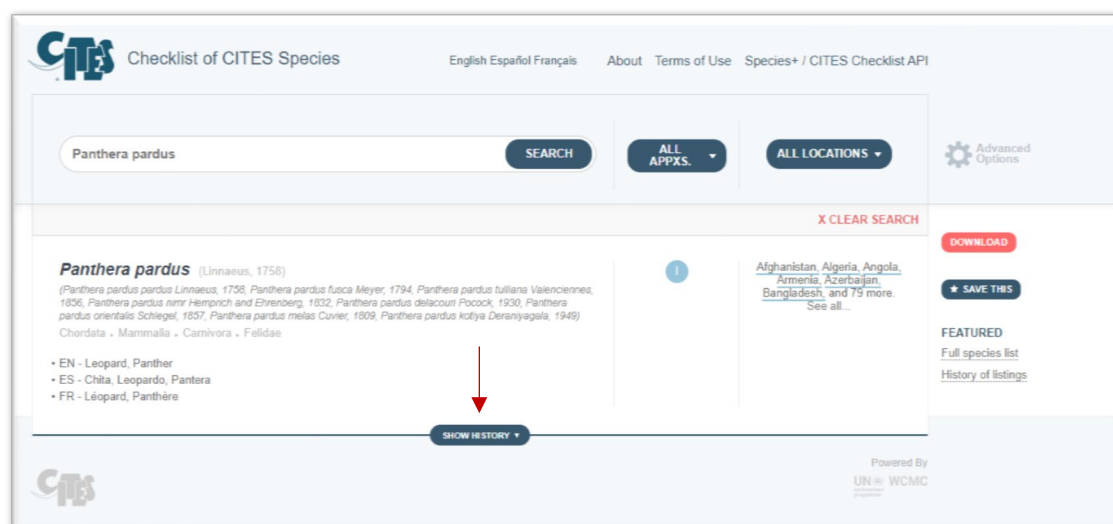
This is the best download type for users wanting to access materials for a select group of species (e.g. seahorses) or a specific taxonomic group from a specific location (e.g. cacti of Mexico).





2.3 Individual Taxon Entries

Finally, users have the option to download relevant identification materials for individual taxa by clicking the 'SHOW MORE' button that appears at the bottom of each taxon entry when hovered over by the mouse. Options are given to download relevant entries from the CITES Identification Manual and/or to navigate to relevant materials from the CITES Virtual College by clicking on entries shown under 'Other identification materials'. These options will only show when materials are available.



Panthera pardus (Linnaeus, 1758)

(Panthera pardus kotiya Deraniyagala, 1949; Panthera pardus melas Cuvier, 1829; Panthera pardus fusca Meyer, 1794; Panthera pardus orientalis Schlegel, 1857; Panthera pardus nimr Hemprich and Ehrenberg, 1832; Panthera pardus pardus Linnaeus, 1758; Panthera pardus delacour Pocock, 1930; Panthera pardus tulliana Valenciennes, 1856)

Chordata - Mammalia - Carnivora - Felidae

- EN - Leopard, Panther
- ES - Chita, Leopardo, Pantera
- FR - Léopard, Panthère

CITES history

1975 1980 1985 1990 1995 2000 2005 2010 2015 2020

CITES Identification Manual entries

Download all ID Manual entries for *Panthera pardus*

Other identification materials

Traditional Asian Medicine Identification Guide for Law Enforcers: Version II EN

HIDE

3. Citation

CITES Identification Manual materials downloaded through the Checklist site should be cited as follows:

UNEP-WCMC (Comps.) 2020. Checklist of CITES species – CITES Identification Manual. CITES Secretariat, Geneva, Switzerland, and UNEP-WCMC, Cambridge, United Kingdom. Accessed on [Date].

Materials listed as “Other identification materials” should follow citation advice contained within each resource.